ANALYSTLAB AFRICA

PROJECT CHARTER

Consumer Complaint Trends and Response Intelligence Platform

Week 4 • Batch F
Track: Project Management
Document Version: 1.0
Status: Proposed planning document

Document Control

Field	Details
Programme	Experience Lab Internship Programme
Assignment	Week 4 – Batch F
Project	Consumer Complaint Trends and Response Intelligence Platform
Track	Project Management
Version	1.0
Document status	Proposed Project Charter
Source assignment	AnalystLab Africa Week 4 Official Weekly Assignment, Version 1.0
Dataset period	1 May 2017 to 28 August 2023
Approval status	For review; formal approval authority and named approvers to be confirmed

1. Project Background

Financial institutions receive complaints from consumers about a range of financial products and services, including account management, credit cards, mortgages, credit reporting and payment services. The Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (CFPB) collects consumer complaints and forwards eligible complaints to the relevant companies for review and response.

For this project, AnalystLab Africa is using consumer complaint records relating to Bank of America from 2017 to 2023 to simulate a professional financial services analytics engagement. The supplied records cover 1 May 2017 to 28 August 2023 and contain 62,516 complaint records in a single worksheet with 12 fields.

The project will coordinate five connected workstreams—Data Analytics, Data Science, Machine Learning, Generative AI and Project Management—to develop an integrated complaint intelligence solution. The solution is intended to support understanding of complaint trends, frequently reported issues, products associated with complaints, recorded company responses and complaint-processing timelines.

A complaint is an issue reported by a consumer. It does not, by itself, establish misconduct or prove that the company has violated a regulation. All findings must be objective and supported by the available data.

2. Project Problem Statement

Stakeholders require a reliable and accessible way to monitor consumer complaints and understand patterns in the complaints recorded against Bank of America. The supplied dataset contains fields that can support analysis of complaint volumes, products, reported issues, company response classifications, response timeliness and the interval between CFPB receipt and forwarding to the company.

The project must prepare and validate the data, establish consistent metric definitions, and coordinate analytical, statistical, predictive and AI-enabled outputs. The integrated solution should help stakeholders answer the ten business questions set out in the Week 4 assignment, including changes in complaint volumes from 2017 to 2023, product and issue distributions, forwarding intervals, recorded response categories, timely-response indicators and the feasibility of forecasting future complaint volumes.

Questions that cannot be answered from the supplied fields must be identified and documented rather than inferred.

3. Business Justification

The project is intended to turn the supplied complaint records into documented, validated and accessible information. Bringing the five workstreams together can provide a more complete view than producing isolated technical outputs.

- Improve visibility of complaint volumes and historical patterns.
- Identify financial products and reported issues associated with higher complaint volumes.

- Examine recorded company response categories and response-timeliness indicators.
- Measure the CFPB complaint-forwarding interval using the two supplied date fields, without misrepresenting it as company resolution time.
- Explore whether historical monthly complaint patterns can support a forecast prototype.
- Provide stakeholders with access to validated insights through a dashboard and an AI-powered assistant.
- Demonstrate coordinated, reproducible and responsible multidisciplinary project delivery.

This is a simulated internship project. The charter does not imply that Bank of America has commissioned, approved or committed to implementing the proposed solution.

4. Project Objectives

The overall objective is to plan, coordinate and monitor delivery of a professional, documented and validated Consumer Complaint Intelligence Platform across all five internship tracks.

- Coordinate inspection, cleaning and validation of the supplied complaint dataset while preserving the original source file and documenting transformations.
- Establish consistent definitions for complaint volume, product, issue, company response, timely-response indicator and complaint-forwarding interval.
- Coordinate development of an interactive dashboard to monitor complaint volumes, trends, products, issues and recorded company responses.
- Coordinate exploratory and statistical analysis of complaint patterns and response trends.
- Coordinate development and evaluation of a prototype that forecasts future monthly complaint volumes.
- Coordinate development and evaluation of an AI-powered assistant that provides data-grounded answers using validated complaint information.
- Monitor workstream deliverables, cross-track dependencies, milestones, risks, issues and acceptance criteria.
- Coordinate peer review, integration, documentation, reporting and final handover of outputs that have actually been completed and tested.

5. Project Scope

5.1 In-Scope Activities

- Project initiation, charter development and definition of project objectives, scope and expected outcomes.
- Identification of stakeholders, deliverables, acceptance criteria, assumptions and dependencies.
- Development of the WBS, project schedule, task ownership, milestones and RACI matrix.
- Preparation of stakeholder communication arrangements.
- Identification and monitoring of project risks and issues, including the risks specified in the assignment.
- Coordination of dataset inspection, data-quality checks, cleaning, date validation and documentation.
- Coordination of dashboard development and KPI calculations.
- Coordination of exploratory data analysis, statistical testing where assumptions are satisfied, and interpretation of findings.
- Coordination of monthly complaint aggregation, forecasting model development, chronological validation and evaluation.
- Coordination of AI assistant knowledge preparation, grounded numerical responses, evaluation questions and safeguards.
- Monitoring progress, blockers, decisions, peer reviews, acceptance criteria and delivery against the schedule.
- Coordination of integration review, progress reporting, final documentation and handover.

5.2 Out-of-Scope Activities

- Conducting an official regulatory investigation or audit of Bank of America.

- Determining whether Bank of America committed misconduct or violated a law or regulation based solely on complaint records.
- Predicting actual misconduct, regulatory breaches or future company performance.
- Building or deploying a production-ready banking, customer relationship management or complaint-management system.
- Processing banking transactions, accessing customer accounts or changing customer records.
- Sentiment analysis or narrative-based complaint summarisation, because detailed complaint narratives are not included in the supplied dataset.
- Presenting the AI assistant as an official CFPB or Bank of America service.
- Adding material functionality outside the assignment requirements without documented assessment and approval through change control.

6. Expected Project Outcomes

Subject to completion, validation and review, the project is expected to produce:

- A cleaned dataset or reproducible data-preparation process, with data-quality and transformation documentation.
- An interactive complaint monitoring dashboard with documented KPIs and filters.
- An exploratory and statistical analysis notebook or equivalent reproducible work, with supported findings and limitations.
- A complaint-volume forecasting prototype with model comparisons, evaluation metrics, forecast visualisations and error analysis.
- An AI-powered complaint insights assistant grounded in validated information, with documented testing and safeguards.
- An integrated project documentation pack covering scope, schedule, responsibilities, risks, testing, coordination and handover.

7. Stakeholders and Roles

Stakeholder	Interest / proposed responsibility
AnalystLab Africa / Programme Management	Programme context, assignment requirements and overall programme oversight.
Programme Mentor / Reviewer	Reviews submitted work, provides feedback and assesses deliverables.
Project Manager (Project Management Track)	Coordinates the integrated plan, schedule, dependencies, risks, communication, monitoring, reporting and handover.
Data Analytics workstream	Inspects and prepares data; defines and calculates KPIs; develops the complaint monitoring dashboard and business insights.
Data Science workstream	Conducts exploratory data analysis, develops research questions, applies appropriate statistical methods and interprets findings.
Machine Learning workstream	Prepares monthly complaint series, develops and evaluates forecasting methods, and documents model limitations.
Generative AI workstream	Prepares validated knowledge sources, develops the assistant, tests response grounding and implements safeguards.
Other workstream contributors	Provide technical input, complete assigned tasks and communicate progress, blockers and dependencies.
Intended users of the outputs	Use the resulting validated complaint insights for monitoring and business understanding.

The assignment does not name an individual project sponsor or specify a formal approval hierarchy. These roles and authorities must therefore be confirmed by the programme rather than assumed.

8. Key Project Deliverables

Workstream	Required outputs
Project Management	Project charter; WBS; Gantt chart or project schedule; RACI matrix; risk and issue register; stakeholder communication plan; task and milestone tracker; final project status report; evidence of coordination and delivery.

Data Analytics	Cleaned dataset or reproducible cleaning process; SQL queries or analytical scripts; KPI definitions and calculations; interactive dashboard; at least five business insights; at least three actionable recommendations; README and data-quality documentation.
Data Science	Reproducible analysis notebook; data preparation documentation; research questions and hypotheses; exploratory analysis and visualisations; statistical analysis and interpretation; at least three supported findings; analytical report and limitations.
Machine Learning	Reproducible modelling notebook or source code; prediction target and features; baseline and model comparison; evaluation metrics; forecast visualisations; error analysis; limitations and recommendations; saved model or reproducible training workflow where appropriate.
Generative AI	Working AI assistant prototype; documented data sources and KPI definitions; system instructions and configuration; at least 20 evaluation questions; evaluation results; evidence of grounded numerical responses; README, limitations and safeguards.

The Project Manager coordinates and monitors the workstreams but does not replace the technical responsibility of each assigned track. Each intern remains responsible for their own track-specific technical deliverables.

9. Acceptance Criteria

Project management output	Acceptance criteria / evidence
Project Charter	Defines the project background, problem, objectives, scope, outcomes, stakeholders, deliverables, assumptions and dependencies.
WBS	Breaks the project scope into structured, identifiable work packages covering all five workstreams and project coordination.
Gantt chart / project schedule	Shows activities, proposed durations, task owners, sequence, cross-track dependencies and milestones. Dates are identified as proposed until confirmed.
RACI matrix	Identifies Responsible, Accountable, Consulted and Informed roles for key project activities and deliverables.
Risk and issue register	Records relevant risks and issues with probability, impact, mitigation or response, owner and status, as applicable.
Stakeholder communication plan	Identifies the audience, information to be communicated, method, frequency and communication owner.
Task and milestone tracker	Records tasks, owners, due dates, planned and actual status, progress, blockers and milestone completion.
Final project status report	Summarises progress against plan, completed and outstanding outputs, risks, issues, decisions, blockers and next steps.
Coordination and delivery evidence	Provides genuine records of progress reviews, peer reviews, decisions, revisions, integration checks and handover. Evidence must reflect activities actually performed.

Technical workstream outputs must meet their own assignment-specific requirements and be validated by the relevant technical contributors. A project management artefact being prepared does not, by itself, demonstrate that the underlying technical deliverable has been completed.

10. Project Governance and Control

The project will use an integrated coordination approach. The Project Manager will maintain the consolidated project plan and monitor progress across the five workstreams. Each workstream remains accountable for the technical quality and completion of its assigned outputs.

- Planning and baseline control: maintain the agreed scope, WBS, schedule, owners, milestones and acceptance criteria.
- Progress monitoring: update the task and milestone tracker using status information supplied by workstream contributors.
- Risk and issue management: record, assess, assign and monitor risks and issues; escalate matters requiring a decision.
- Dependency management: monitor shared data, KPI definitions, technical prerequisites and hand-offs between workstreams.
- Change control: document proposed changes, assess their effect on scope, schedule, resources and quality, and obtain the appropriate decision before incorporating approved changes.
- Quality and integration: coordinate peer reviews, reconcile shared metric definitions and check that integrated outputs use validated and consistent information.
- Reporting and handover: prepare progress reporting and coordinate handover of outputs only when completion and testing are evidenced.

The reporting frequency, escalation route and formal decision authority will be confirmed during detailed planning. Until confirmed, any proposed meeting cadence or reporting cycle will be treated as a planning proposal, not an established programme requirement.

11. Assumptions

- The supplied Consumer_Complaints.xlsx file and ConsumerComplaints_DataDictionary.csv are the primary project data resources.
- The project uses the supplied Bank of America complaint records covering 1 May 2017 to 28 August 2023.
- All five internship tracks contribute to one integrated project, while each intern remains responsible for their assigned track's technical deliverables.
- Workstream contributors will communicate progress, blockers, decisions and dependencies to support coordination.
- Suitable tools and working environments will be available to complete the assigned activities; the specific tools may differ by workstream.
- The original dataset will be preserved and transformations will be documented and reproducible.
- Project dates, durations, named task owners and reporting arrangements will be confirmed during detailed planning.
- Mentor feedback may require revisions to the work, and meaningful revisions will be recorded.

12. Constraints and Limitations

- The analysis is limited to the fields and records supplied in the assignment dataset.
- The dataset does not contain detailed complaint narratives; narrative-based analysis and sentiment analysis are therefore outside scope.
- The supplied reporting period ends on 28 August 2023 and does not represent current complaint activity.
- Missing values and the meaning of categorical fields must be investigated and documented before analysis.
- Blank values in the Timely response? field must not automatically be classified as No; the assignment notes that blanks are associated with records marked In progress.
- The difference between Date submitted and Date received represents the CFPB complaint-forwarding interval, not the company's response or resolution time.
- The first and last reporting months are partial periods and must be handled appropriately in forecasting.
- Forecasting performance may be constrained by the length, completeness and characteristics of the historical series.
- The AI assistant must not invent allegations, make legal conclusions or represent itself as an official CFPB or Bank of America service.
- The project is subject to the internship programme submission deadline and available time and resources.

13. Key Cross-Track Dependencies

Precondition / dependency	Work that depends on it	Project management implication
Dataset inspection, cleaning and validation	Dashboard, statistical analysis, forecasting and AI knowledge preparation	Coordinate a shared data-readiness checkpoint and document data-quality decisions.
Agreed KPI and field definitions	Dashboard, analysis outputs and AI numerical answers	Maintain a common metric-definition reference and communicate approved changes.
Monthly complaint aggregation and treatment of partial periods	Forecasting model development and evaluation	Confirm time-series preparation and validation approach before model evaluation.
Validated calculations and analytical outputs	AI assistant's numerical responses and source grounding	Require the assistant to use validated calculations or controlled analytical outputs.
Completion of individual workstream outputs	Integration and final review	Track hand-offs, review status and outstanding defects.
Testing, documentation and review evidence	Final reporting and handover	Do not mark an output complete until required evidence is available.

14. Indicative Project Milestones

The assignment does not prescribe a total project duration or calendar start and end dates. The following milestone sequence is therefore indicative. Detailed durations, dates and owners will be established in the project schedule.

Milestone	Indicative completion evidence
M1 – Initiation	Project charter and initial scope documented.
M2 – Planning	WBS, schedule, task ownership, RACI and project registers prepared.
M3 – Data readiness	Dataset inspection, cleaning and validation evidence available; shared definitions documented.
M4 – Workstream development	Track-specific analysis, dashboard, forecasting and AI development outputs progressed.
M5 – Testing and review	Technical validation, peer review, evaluation and limitations documented.
M6 – Integration	Cross-track outputs reviewed for consistent definitions, data and hand-offs.
M7 – Final reporting and handover	Status report, final documentation, presentation and evidence of completed delivery prepared.

15. Project Success Criteria

The project will be considered successful when the following conditions are met, subject to the assignment requirements and available evidence:

- All five workstreams have contributed their assigned outputs and documented their individual contributions.
- Project objectives, scope, deliverables, roles and dependencies are documented and consistently understood.
- The dataset preparation process and key metric definitions are documented and reproducible.
- Dashboard and analytical findings are supported by validated calculations and clearly stated filters and reporting periods.
- Statistical conclusions distinguish association from causation and explain relevant limitations.
- The forecasting prototype is assessed using an appropriate chronological validation approach and documented evaluation metrics.
- The AI assistant is evaluated using valid, ambiguous and unsupported questions and provides grounded numerical responses with appropriate safeguards.
- Project risks, issues, changes, tasks and milestones are recorded and monitored.
- Cross-track integration and peer review are evidenced.
- Final reporting, documentation, individual presentation and handover materials are organised and complete.
- All conclusions distinguish consumer-reported complaints from verified facts and do not treat recorded company responses as proof of satisfactory resolution.

16. Charter Review and Approval

This charter is a proposed planning document prepared for the Week 4 Project Management assignment. It establishes the project direction and provides the basis for developing the detailed WBS, schedule, RACI matrix, risk and issue register, communication plan and monitoring tools.

The official assignment does not identify a named project sponsor, formal approval authority or individual team members. The relevant names and approval arrangements should be completed only when confirmed by the programme.

Review / approval role	Name	Status / date
Project Manager / Project Management Track Intern	To be completed	Prepared for review
Programme Mentor / Reviewer	To be confirmed	Pending review
Project Sponsor / Programme Authority (if designated)	To be confirmed	Approval authority to be confirmed

17. Source and Reference

Primary source: AnalystLab Africa, Experience Lab Internship Programme, Official Weekly Assignment, Week 4: Consumer Complaint Trends and Response Intelligence Platform, Version 1.0. Project background and requirements are drawn from the supplied assignment, particularly Sections 1–7.

Supplied data resources: Consumer_Complaints.xlsx and ConsumerComplaints_DataDictionary.csv.

No external findings about Bank of America have been introduced into this charter. Project assumptions and proposed planning arrangements are identified as such.